

Antonio Carmagnani

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Dear Hiring Team at Drees & Sommer,

I trained as an architect, and the part of the work that has always drawn me most is the one that comes before the project itself - understanding what a site is worth and what it could become once its regulatory and physical constraints are properly read. Following that question is what took me from architecture practice into development feasibility, and then to a Master's Degree in Architecture Computation at The Royal Danish Academy, where I specialised in the computational and data methods that allow those questions to be answered with evidence rather than intuition. Alongside that, the environmental performance of buildings has been a constant thread in my work, from assessing the energy performance of assets a bank was acquiring to ESG due diligence for real estate investment managers, which is increasingly part of what an asset is worth rather than a separate conversation about it. Drees & Sommer puts both halves in one seat, the project carried from early planning through delivery and the technical assessment that tells a client what they are taking on.

My work at Sweco extended into the commercial side of the practice, where I wrote the technical and methodology sections of competitive international tenders, assembled bid teams around the specialist expertise each procurement required, and built a pricing tool that parametrised expert fee bands and project economics so that bid decisions rested on figures rather than on judgement alone. Alongside that I joined field missions across Baku's water supply system, where I sat with national water agencies and government counterparts to align on rehabilitation priorities and gather the technical data the project needed. That combination taught me how a consultancy actually wins and then delivers work, and how much of it depends on being precise with people who are not obliged to agree with you. Coordinating technical and commercial work packages, and being the contact consultants and partners deal with, is that work continued.

At Itaú-Unibanco I reviewed technical documentation from architecture and engineering firms before construction was authorised, checking drawings against Brazilian building, accessibility and fire-safety standards, and assessed the environmental and energy performance of buildings the bank was acquiring or leasing by reviewing consumption data, efficiency ratings and certifications as part of internal due diligence. Sitting on the owner's side of that process taught me what an institution actually needs to see before it commits to a building, which is a different and narrower question than the one a design team asks. Technical due diligence asks that question for someone else's money, which is the same discipline with a client on the other side of it.

Drees & Sommer sits on both sides of a project, advising and then delivering, across logistics, data centres and commercial assets. That is where I want to bring the architect's reading of an asset and the analytical side of my work into the same job, applied to real assets and to decisions with money behind them.

Best,

Antonio Carmagnani